

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I am broadly interested in Computational Linguistics and Natural Language Processing, specifically (1) Human-AI alignment, (2) Developing robust evaluation frameworks for LLMs, and (3) Investigating model internals to advance LLM interpretability and AI safety.

EDUCATION

Jahangirnagar University

Master of Science in Computer Science

Dhaka, Bangladesh

May 2025 – Sept. 2026

- **Current CGPA:** 3.97/4.00
- **Relevant Coursework:** Machine Learning (A+), Deep Learning (A+), Natural Language Processing (A+), Data Mining (A), Artificial Intelligence & Expert Systems (A+), Computational Intelligence (A+)
- **CS Prerequisites:** Data Structures & Algorithms (A+), Software Engineering & Database Systems (A+), Computer Architecture & Operating Systems (A+), Programming Languages (A+)

Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology (BUET)

Bachelor of Science in Civil Engineering, with Honors

Dhaka, Bangladesh

Feb. 2020 – Mar. 2025

- **CGPA:** 3.77/4.00, **Major:** Transportation Engineering, **Minor:** Environmental Engineering
- **Math and Programming Coursework:** Differential Equations & Statistics (A+), Differential, Integral Calculus and Matrices, Computer Programming Sessional (A+), Engineering Computation Sessional (A+)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Researcher

Computational Intelligence, Data and Language Research Lab

Supervisor: Dr. Md. Musfique Anwar

Jun. 2025 – Present

Jahangirnagar University

- * **Mechanistic Interpretability:** Co-conceptualized a study of arithmetic heuristic neurons across three Llama models (1B/3B/8B), testing (1) whether arithmetic neurons are form-invariant across symbolic, python code, and natural language word-problem formulations and (2) whether cross-format failures reflect distinct circuits or differential activation of a shared circuit; conducted experiments on the 1B-parameter model and co-authored the manuscript. Identified a compact, causally sufficient shared circuit whose activation transfer recovered over 97% of cross-format failures for addition and subtraction, with lower recovery for multiplication and division.
- * **Event Extraction:** Led a comprehensive study of event detection from Bangla news, developing a generalized news event ontology, coordinating annotation of 9,979 sentences across 40 subtypes and three noise conditions, and training and evaluating encoder-based and decoder-only models; found decoder-only LLMs markedly more robust to noise, while annotation-guided instruction tuning improved performance but did not consistently improve robustness.
- * **Cultural Alignment:** Led *BanglaSocialBench* end-to-end, integrating LLM APIs, building evaluation pipelines, coordinating annotation, and conducting statistical analyses for a 1,719-instance benchmark evaluated across 12 LLMs; uncovered systematic over-politeness, failure to recognize multiple socially acceptable address-pronoun forms, and cross-religious kinship-term conflation (ACL SRW 2026, Best Paper Award).

Research Intern

Maks Inc.

Dhaka, Bangladesh (HQ: Frisco, TX, USA)

- * Conducted literature reviews and collaborated with data scientists and transportation engineers to analyze large-scale BRTA traffic datasets, develop emission models, perform geospatial analyses, and conduct in-person stakeholder interviews across major administrative divisions of Bangladesh; prepared technical reports for projects funded by the **World Bank** and **Asian Development Bank**.

Undergraduate Researcher

Advised by: Dr. Md. Shamsul Hoque & Dr. Md Asif Raihan

Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology

- * Built an end-to-end computer vision and machine learning framework integrating street-view imagery, open geospatial data, and crash records to determine the impact of visual and built-environment characteristics on pedestrian crash severity, applying SHAP-based interpretability techniques.

* indicates equal contribution

- [1] Sharath Naganna*, Tanvir Ahmed Sijan*, Uddipta Kalita. **"Are Arithmetic Heuristic Neurons Form-Invariant? A Mechanistic Analysis of Symbols, Text, and Code in LLMs."** *arXiv preprint arXiv:2607.16693*, July, 2026. [[arXiv](#)]
- [2] Tanvir Ahmed Sijan, S. M Golam Rifat, Nayeemul Islam, Md. Musfique Anwar. **"Beyond Clean Text: Evaluating Encoder and Decoder Robustness for Bangla Event Detection in Noisy Text."** *arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.30914*, June, 2026. [[arXiv](#)]
- [3] Tanvir Ahmed Sijan, S. M Golam Rifat, Pankaj Chowdhury Partha, Md. Tanjeed Islam, Md. Musfique Anwar. **"BanglaSocialBench: A Benchmark for Evaluating Sociopragmatic and Cultural Alignment of LLMs in Bangladeshi Social Interaction."** *ACL Student Research Workshop (Oral)*, 2026. [**Best Paper Award**] [[ACL Anthology](#)]
- [4] Tanvir Ahmed Sijan, Md Asif Raihan, Sk. Md. Mashrur, Md. Shamsul Hoque. **"Assessing the Visual and Built Environment Risk on Pedestrian-Vehicle Crash Severity in Absence of Detailed Roadway Inventory: A Deep Learning Based Framework Harnessing Public Geospatial Data."** *Submitted to Transportation Research Board*, 2026.

HONORS & AWARDS

Best Paper Award	Jul. 2026
<i>ACL Student Research Workshop 2026</i>	
Degree Awarded with Honors	Mar. 2025
<i>Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology (BUET)</i>	
Undergraduate Student Research Grant	Jan. 2024
<i>Research and Innovation Centre for Science and Engineering, BUET</i>	
Dean's List Scholarship	Jul. 2019
<i>Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology (BUET)</i>	
◦ Awarded for maintaining an average GPA of 3.75 or above across two consecutive regular terms.	
3rd Place, Concrete Solutions Competition	Mar. 2022
<i>American Concrete Institute (ACI)</i>	
◦ Recognized for most innovative team design; featured in Daily Prothom Alo [Feature]	
Higher Secondary Certificate (HSC) Scholarship	2019
<i>Board of Intermediate and Secondary Education, Rajshahi</i>	
◦ Awarded Talentpool Scholarship ; ranked 10th (~top 0.01%) among all candidates in the Rajshahi Board.	

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

Workshop Reviewer	Jul. 2026
<i>11th Workshop on Natural User-generated Text (W-NUT) collocated with EMNLP 2026</i>	
Deputy Vice President	Dec. 2024 – Mar. 2025
<i>ITE BUET Student Chapter</i>	
◦ Collaborated with executive members to organize workshops and seminars on various topics of transportation research.	
Vice President	Mar. 2024 – Mar. 2025
<i>ACI BUET Student Chapter</i>	
◦ Organized poster competitions, seminars, and field visits in coordination with chapter members.	

SKILLS

Programming: Python, C, C++, SQL, MATLAB
Libraries: PyTorch, NumPy, Pandas, Transformers, Matplotlib, Scikit-Learn
Other: Linux, Git, Bash, $\LaTeX$
Languages: Bangla (Native), English, Hindi (Basic)